The Great Controversy

(The Origin of Evil)

Purpose: To show there is a cosmic conflict between God and Satan, that planet Earth is its theatre and worship is its centre

Centred on: Origin of evil, Outworking of evil & Obsolescence (end) of evil.

Origin:

Genesis 1: 1-4; 1: 10; 1: 12; 1: 17-18; 1: 21; 1: 25; 1: 31.

Matthew 13:24-30; 37-39. *(An enemy has done this)*

Luke 13:10-16. *(Satan/the adversary has bound her)* Sa-Tawn = Enemy

Question: How much responsibility did Jesus take for this woman's infirmed condition?

Answer: None! He took as much responsibility for the woman's condition as he took for the tares among the wheat. In both cases he places the responsibility squarely on the shoulders of some enemy! Who is this enemy? Who is Satan/the devil?

Luke 10: 1; 17-20…**Question**: According to these verses, where did Satan come from?

Answer: Verse 18- I saw Satan fall like lightening from heaven.

What we will discover, is that this power that originates evil that brought pain, suffering, sickness, death, disease & despair into the world *is actually a fallen angel turned into a devil.* There are two (three) primary passages in the OT that describe this rebellion against the government of God.

Ezekiel 28: 12-19; Isaiah 14:12-14 **; Job 1&2**

Ezekiel 28: 12-19…Note the description of "perfect" mentioned in verse 12 & 15. Furthermore, in verse 14 there are three separate images used her to describe this angel's proximity to God.

1. You were the anointed cherub who covers. (Sanctuary language).
2. You were on the Holy mountain of God. (In Gods immediate presence, e.g. Sinai, Moriah).
3. You walked back and forth in the midst of fiery stones. (Rev 15:2)

A Jew wouldn't need this explained – It's a Poetic Chiasm ABABBABA

In verse 16, we find all the proximal aspects of Satan were reversed. Note in verse 16 & 18 we find the term "trading" used to describe the workings of Satan. Satan was a kind of "salesman".

The same root word here for **"Trading"** in the original Hebrew language is the same root word for **Gossip and/or telling lies.** Satan was therefore telling lies about God and his government!
He was selling an idea.

God shows that the responsibility falls on Lucifer for his fall.

Isaiah 14: 12-15…Note 4 lessons contained in verse 13, 14 & 15.

1. There are 5 phrases here that all begin with the "I will" – A war of wills (self-centred war of wills)
2. Note all of the references to "upward motion"
3. The desire to go all the way up, eventually leads to the opposite.
4. The Hebrew poetic chiasm presented in verses 13 & 14, highlights Satan's ultimate objective. –shows prideful ambition

Conclusion: According to scripture, evil began in an angelic rebellion against the government of God. God's government hinges on voluntary loyalty, obedience and love. Love cannot be compelled! Forced love is rape. God allows all of his creatures to choose either for him or against him.

Outworking of evil: (operation)

There is a cosmic conflict going on between God and Satan where Worship is its centre!

Matthew 4: 1-11…Wow! Here we have a created being asking the creator to worship him! What insanity and folly! (Jesus is the creator – see John 1:1-4,14)

Conclusion: The longing desire of Satan's heart is for that which he does not deserve. Worship is the centre point issue. Satan desires our allegiance, loyalty and Worship…Who do we worship?

Revelation 13: 1-4...We find the dragon to be symbolic of Satan in *Rev 12: 9*. Furthermore, we find in verse 4 that people in the last days will be worshiping both the Beast and the Dragon.

At this point we should look not at the symbols here but at the relationship they represent.

Do not miss the Major points:

1. The antichrist deceiver is the *front man* for the dragon in order to receive worship!
2. Worship is the central issue in this conflict!

We will now look at the worship texts in *Rev 13 & 14.* There are 8 in total, amplifying the critical issue in the context of the last day's deception. Additionally, we find the element of forced worship in *Rev 13: 12, 14 & 15* in contrast to the freedom of worship granted by God.

1 John 4:8..This shows the contrast between God & Satan

Matthew 11:28-30...This is in contrast (Coercion vs. Compassion) to rev 13/14. Come – invitation; Meek, Gentle, Lowly.

Obsolescence (end) of evil: (Chiasm)

Philippians 2: 5-11…Note the reverse parallel of Jesus self-condescension in relation to Satan's self-exaltation noted in *Isaiah 14: 13-15.* Self-exaltation at the expense of others, or condescension for the better of others. **ATV 7-8** Jesus was 1. No reputation 2. Form of a slave 3. Likeness of mankind 4. Humbled himself 5. Obedient to death 6. Even the death of the cross

Rev 21:1-4

Rev 22:1-4

Genesis 1, 2……Eden to Eden……Revelation 21, 22

First battle- Genesis 3……Last battle- Revelation 20

The centre of this battle is God's love for us demonstrated at the Cross! There are two backdrops here. A face to face relationship with God and Conflict.

Apologetics:

Questions

#1 Why did God create Satan?
#2 Why did God create Lucifer if he knew he would rebel?
#3 What is the future like?
#4 Why did Lucifer Rebel?

Answers

#1 God didn't create Satan, he created Lucifer. Lucifer had his own freewill like us.
#2 What God foreknows, is not necessarily what he fore chose. (Pre-recorded game eg.)
#3 A. God chose (Calvinism- predestination) B. God knows (certainties-Armenianism) C. Finite decisions from finite being – God knows (possibilities-open theism)
#4 It is unknown why Lucifer rebelled against God. (GC 525)

Explanation: If God wants genuine love then he must be willing to risk all! The ultimate rationale for the rebellion of Satan is unknown; the Bible calls this the "Mystery of iniquity" ***(2 Thessalonians 2:7).***

E.G. White states:

"To many minds, the origin of sin and the reason for its existence are a source of great perplexity. In their interest in these questions, the truths plainly revealed in God's word and essential to salvation are neglected; and the fact that the Scriptures furnish no explanation, is seized upon as an excuse for rejecting the words of Holy Writ.

It is impossible to explain the origin of sin, or to give a reason for its existence. It is an intruder, for whose existence no reason can be given. It is mysterious, unaccountable; to excuse it, is to defend it. Could it be excused, could a cause be shown for its existence, it would cease to be sin. Our only definition of sin is that given in the word of God; it is "the transgression of the law."

The Spirit of Prophecy, Volume 4, Chapter 24. - Origin of Evil.

If NO isn't an option, YES means nothing.

LOVE requires FREEDOM { chinese election}
FREEDOM involves RISK { teenager with keys}
RISK entails RESPONSIBILTY
RESPONSIBILTY produces MORALITY growth

#1 Create nothing – Lonely loveless universe
#2 Create robots – Forced love ….meaningless
#3 Create free beings – Risk. Rom 8:18 God says the risk is worth the reward.

The Bible affirms the reality of suffering but it maximises glory.
This isn't the best possible world but it's the way to the best possible world. Total Freedom, Total Love.
One man can only suffer his own pain but Jesus suffers all man's pain.
God gave Evil permission he never promoted it. Luke 7:29,30

Evil is not a thing it's the absence of a thing – Love (to have evil you must first have something whole)

The problem of Evil: (If we eliminate one of these so to the problem)

#1 God is all-loving (He would eliminate evil)

#2 God is all powerful (He could eliminate evil)

#3 Evil exists (God doesn't eliminate evil)

Matthew 13:24-30

#1 An enemy is responsible for evil

#2 We want evil to end now

#3 But evil must be allowed to mature

#4 In the end, evil will be seen for what it is

#5 At "the end" God can destroy evil without harming the good

God's options:

#1 Create nothing (Loveless universe)

#2 Create free beings (Love filled universe)

#3 Create free beings who cannot sin (internal contradiction)

#4 Create robots

God's known characteristics before the cross

Creator, Sustainer, Social, Loving, Generous, etc…The absence of sin prevented knowing how good God is (not self-sacrificing Love -see Luke 8:26-28)
At the cross the uncertainty of God's Love became certain – *Grace, Merciful, Just, Selfless, Humble*
Our need is the qualification which gives us the assurance that we shall receive this gift.

John 12:31,32

- Now judgement of this world
- NOW ruler (Archon gk)of this world cast out – (All this I will give you if you will worship me)
- WHEN I am lifted up (Cross)

Rev 12:7-13

- War (polemos gk, politics) broke out in heaven. A war of ideas
- Michael (5 times, warrior name for Christ- one who is like God)vs Dragon(Daniel 12:1,Jude 9,Zech 3:1-5, Cast down 3X
- NOW cast down, Sin – Jesus sinless life, Death – Jesus' victory over death

We do not live in the best possible world but We do live in the world with the best possibilities.

This world is the way to the best possible world.